Activity 7: Investigate the PulseMed ESD Incident

Objective: Contain risk, preserve evidence, identify system causes and produce a verified CAPA plan.

Scenario

PulseMed sees intermittent failures in a safety-relevant control board after a temporary operator used ordinary bubble wrap near final test. A monitor alarm was acknowledged but production continued for 47 minutes.

Roles

- incident lead
- production manager
- quality/reliability representative

Detailed procedure

1. Initiate stop-work and quarantine product handled during the exposure window.
2. Preserve monitor logs, tester results, packaging samples, workstation state and operator accounts.
3. Create a verified timeline from the first process change to containment.
4. Define the problem using product, place, time, extent and observed symptoms without assuming causation.
5. Map direct, induction and CDM exposure pathways created by the bubble wrap and handling sequence.
6. Use a fishbone and five-whys analysis across method, material, machine, measurement, people and management.
7. Identify root, contributing and detection causes; avoid ending at 'operator error'.
8. Select immediate correction, systemic corrective action and preventive action for similar areas.
9. Define affected-product disposition and the technical evidence required for release or scrap.
10. Assign CAPA owners, dates, resources and leading indicators.
11. Define an effectiveness review after implementation, including observation, field measurement and recurrence checks.
12. Prepare a factual incident report and a psychologically safe learning briefing.

Questions

- Which system weakness allowed the alarm to be ignored?
- What evidence must be preserved before resetting the workstation?

- How will you prove the CAPA was effective?

Evidence to submit

- Containment record
- Timeline and causal analysis
- CAPA plan
- Effectiveness-verification plan

Acceptance criteria

- [ ] Exposure window and product scope are defined
- [ ] Causes extend beyond individual blame
- [ ] Actions address root and detection causes
- [ ] Effectiveness has measurable evidence

Debrief

Explain which evidence changed your first assumption, which control is most reliable, and what follow-up measurement is needed.